

ICS 4111: Embedded Systems & IoT

Practical Exercise 2 – Part A Calculations

michael.irungu | 2026-05-07

CIRCUIT A – Series Circuit (125 V | 20 Ω – 30 Ω – 50 Ω)

1. Total Resistance

In a series circuit, total resistance is the sum of all individual resistances:

$$R_{total} = R1 + R2 + R3$$
$$R_{total} = 20 + 30 + 50$$
$$R_{total} = 100 \Omega$$

2. Total Current (Ohm's Law: $I = V / R$)

$$I_{total} = V / R_{total} = 125 / 100$$
$$I_{total} = 1.25 A$$

In a series circuit the same current flows through every component.

3. Current Through Each Resistor

$$I_{R1} = I_{R2} = I_{R3} = 1.25 A \text{ (series circuit - same current everywhere)}$$

4. Voltage Drop Across Each Resistor ($V = I \times R$)

Resistor	Value	Current	Voltage Drop	Check
R1	20 Ω	1.25 A	$V = 1.25 \times 20 = 25.00 V$	✓
R2	30 Ω	1.25 A	$V = 1.25 \times 30 = 37.50 V$	✓
R3	50 Ω	1.25 A	$V = 1.25 \times 50 = 62.50 V$	✓
Total	100 Ω	1.25 A	$25 + 37.5 + 62.5 = 125 V$	$= V_{supply} \checkmark$

5. Power Dissipated (Watt's Law: $P = V \times I$)

Resistor	Voltage Drop	Current	Power ($P = V \times I$)
R1	25.00 V	1.25 A	$P = 25.00 \times 1.25 = 31.25 W$
R2	37.50 V	1.25 A	$P = 37.50 \times 1.25 = 46.875 W$
R3	62.50 V	1.25 A	$P = 62.50 \times 1.25 = 78.125 W$
Total	125 V	1.25 A	$P_{total} = 125 \times 1.25 = 156.25 W$

CIRCUIT B – Parallel Circuit (125 V | 20 Ω || 100 Ω || 50 Ω)

1. Total Resistance

For parallel resistors: $1/R_{total} = 1/R1 + 1/R2 + 1/R3$

$$1/R_{total} = 1/20 + 1/100 + 1/50$$
$$1/R_{total} = 5/100 + 1/100 + 2/100 = 8/100$$
$$R_{total} = 100/8 = 12.5 \Omega$$

2. Total Current

$$I_{total} = V / R_{total} = 125 / 12.5$$
$$I_{total} = 10.0 A$$

3. Current Through Each Resistor ($I = V / R$, each sees full 125 V)

Resistor	Value	Voltage	Current ($I = V/R$)
R1	20 Ω	125 V	$I = 125 / 20 = 6.250 \text{ A}$
R2	100 Ω	125 V	$I = 125 / 100 = 1.250 \text{ A}$
R3	50 Ω	125 V	$I = 125 / 50 = 2.500 \text{ A}$
Total	12.5 Ω	125 V	$I = 6.25+1.25+2.5 = 10.00 \text{ A} \checkmark$

4. Voltage Drop Across Each Resistor

In a parallel circuit every branch is directly connected across the supply:

$V_{R1} = V_{R2} = V_{R3} = 125 \text{ V}$ (equal to supply voltage)

5. Power Dissipated ($P = V \times I$)

Resistor	Voltage	Current	Power ($P = V \times I$)
R1	125 V	6.250 A	$P = 125 \times 6.250 = 781.250 \text{ W}$
R2	125 V	1.250 A	$P = 125 \times 1.250 = 156.250 \text{ W}$
R3	125 V	2.500 A	$P = 125 \times 2.500 = 312.500 \text{ W}$
Total	125 V	10.00 A	$P_{\text{total}} = 125 \times 10 = 1250.000 \text{ W}$

Summary Table

Parameter	Circuit A (Series)	Circuit B (Parallel)
Supply Voltage	125 V	125 V
Total Resistance	100 Ω	12.5 Ω
Total Current	1.25 A	10.00 A
Voltage across R1	25.00 V	125 V
Voltage across R2	37.50 V	125 V
Voltage across R3	62.50 V	125 V
Current through R1	1.25 A	6.25 A
Current through R2	1.25 A	1.25 A
Current through R3	1.25 A	2.50 A
Power in R1	31.25 W	781.25 W
Power in R2	46.875 W	156.25 W
Power in R3	78.125 W	312.50 W
Total Power	156.25 W	1250.00 W